

Draft - expert review pending

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Human Growth and Development - assessment and review

Unit summary

Development is long-term, orderly change across body, thinking, feeling and relationships, driven jointly by growth, maturation and learning. Its sequence is essentially the same for everyone and is never skipped; its rate is individual, so an age-grouped class always contains a wide spread. Heredity sets ranges and the environment fills them, and no classroom observation can separate the two - which is why "that family is just like that" is never a teaching plan.

Physical development runs in two steep phases around a long plateau, with gross motor skills maturing before fine ones. Its teaching consequences are room-scale and cheap: furniture, page spacing, timetables, and a refusal to let bodies become commentary.

Thinking develops through stages: from reasoning led by how things look, through rules held over concrete objects, to reasoning about possibilities. Emotional development is the movement from having feelings to regulating them. Social development runs from attachment through play to the peer group. The three domains feed each other, and every classroom behaviour sits in at least one of them.

The unit's practical shift is the stage reading: compare a pupil's work to stage descriptions, never to the class average, and ask "where is this pupil, and what

is the next step from there?" The teaching that follows is matched rather than accelerated - concrete before symbolic, steps made external, pages that fit the fingers, behaviour read developmentally before morally.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. Development, as this unit uses the word, is best defined as: (*Remember*) a) the physical growth of the body b) long-term, orderly change across body, thinking, feeling and relationships c) the improvement of a pupil's marks over a school year d) the unfolding of sexual maturity in adolescence
2. Which of these is **maturation** rather than learning or growth? (*Understand*) a) knowing the names of the birds in the schoolyard b) reaching the top shelf of the class library c) the arrival of puberty on its own schedule d) using "could" instead of "can" with the head teacher
3. A Class 1 pupil and a Class 5 pupil draw a person differently. The developmental point of the comparison is: (*Understand*) a) the older pupil has better art teaching b) the sequence of drawing development is fixed, but the rate varies between pupils c) the younger pupil lacks fine motor control and needs practice drills d) drawing ability is inherited
4. "Two children with the same birthday can be a year apart in reading." This illustrates: (*Remember*) a) the continuity principle b) the sequence principle c) the rate principle d) the conservation principle
5. Heredity and environment are best described as: (*Understand*) a) competing forces, of which one eventually wins b) heredity setting ranges that the environment fills c) environment setting ranges that heredity fills d) independent of each other in development
6. The two steep phases of physical growth occur in: (*Remember*) a) infancy and middle primary b) early childhood and adolescence c) preoperational and concrete operational stages d) Class 1 and Class 8 only

7. A Class 2 pupil's letters are large and shaky. The most developmentally accurate reading is: *(Apply)* a) the pupil is careless and needs to redo the work b) fine motor control is still maturing, and the page should fit the fingers c) the pupil has a visual problem and needs testing d) the pupil is behind the class average in writing
8. In the two-glasses demonstration, the Class 5 pupil says the amounts are equal "because you just poured it". The pupil is showing: *(Apply)* a) formal operational reasoning b) the preoperational capture by appearance c) conservation - a rule held over concrete objects d) emotional regulation under questioning
9. Which classroom observation most directly reflects **social** development? *(Apply)* a) a pupil who can reverse the steps of a science activity b) a pupil who cries at wrong answers in September but not in March c) the seating map showing one pupil always alone at break d) a pupil whose handwriting has become small and even
10. The stage reading should be run: *(Understand)* a) from age to expectation, so a Class 4 pupil should answer like a Class 4 pupil b) from a pupil's work to the stage it is consistent with, never backwards c) from the class average to the individual pupil d) from heredity to environment, in that order

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. In your own words, explain what development means and name its three engines. *(Understand)*
2. In two sentences, explain the difference between sequence and rate, using the person-drawing evidence. *(Understand)*
3. Allah Dino can tie laces, name birds, and copy sentences he cannot read back. Name the engine most likely behind each ability, in three short lines. *(Apply)*
4. Give two reasons why "small for his age" is almost meaningless for teaching, based on this unit. *(Understand)*
5. Explain, in two sentences, why "heredity or environment?" is a badly formed question, and what a teacher controls regardless. *(Understand)*
6. List the two gains of concrete operational thinking and give one classroom task that needs each. *(Understand)*

7. A pupil cries at wrong answers in September and rarely does by March. Describe what developed and what in the room likely drove it. (*Apply*)
8. Name the two classic errors the stage reading protects a teacher from, with one example of one of them. (*Understand*)
9. Miss Shabana's second lesson began with rotis, not symbols. State the principle this applies and name the order it follows. (*Apply*)
10. In three sentences, read the Class 4 pupil from Topic 2.3's activity ("will not work in groups... shouts when the group complains") through two different domains, and give one response that follows from each. (*Analyze*)

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. **The engines in one pupil.** Allah Dino's case contains evidence for all three engines of development. In a short essay, read his case through growth, maturation and learning, say what evidence supports each reading, and conclude with what Miss Rubina should teach, what she should wait for, and how she can tell the difference. (*Analyze*)
2. **The two staff rooms.** The government school and the private school in Nawabshah explain the same height difference with "food" and "breeding" respectively. Assess both explanations using this unit's principles, and argue what each explanation leads a school to do and not do. (*Analyze*)
3. **Two readings of one pupil.** The trainee who watches the two-glasses video clips concludes that the Class 2 pupil is "weak" and the Class 5 pupil "clever". Evaluate this conclusion: what do the clips demonstrate, what would justify the labels, and what should the difference change for each pupil's teacher? (*Evaluate*)
4. **Matched or mismatched.** Choose one lesson you have taught, observed or received in which content was taught at the wrong level for the class. Analyse the mismatch in developmental terms, and redesign the same content matched to the class's stage, naming the principle that justifies your redesign. (*Create*)
5. **The whole unit in one room.** A colleague describes her Class 3: one pupil who cannot follow two-step instructions without reminders, one whose handwriting defeats every page, one who cries when corrected, and one

who is alone on the seating map. Using the whole unit, analyse the class as four positions on four different developmental roads, and produce a single week's plan of matched responses - one per pupil - with the principle behind each. (*Analyze*)

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **b** - development covers all four domains, not the body alone.
2. **c** - puberty arrives on its own schedule; the other three are learning (a, d) or growth (b).
3. **b** - every child passes the same drawing sequence; only the speed differs.
4. **c** - same age, different reading positions: the rate principle.
5. **b** - heredity supplies the range; the environment decides where inside it a pupil lands.
6. **b** - early childhood and adolescence, with the steady plateau between.
7. **b** - fine motor control matures later than gross; the page is cheaper than the pupil's confidence.
8. **c** - the pupil holds the rule (nothing added or taken away) over real objects: conservation.
9. **c** - the isolated pupil on the peer map is social information; a is cognitive, b is emotional, d is physical.
10. **b** - the reading runs from evidence to stage, because ages are approximate and rate varies.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

Award marks for the substance below, not for matching wording.

1. Long-term, orderly change across body, thinking, feeling and relationships (1); the three engines: growth, maturation, learning (1).
2. Sequence: the order of development is fixed - head-with-legs before bodies before detail (1); rate: the speed varies between pupils, so a Class 1 contains a spread (1).

3. Laces: maturation of motor control (or learning through practice - accept either with a reason) (1); birds: learning from experience (1); copying without reading: learning - specifically a gap in learning, showing copying was taught as shapes (1).
4. Any two of: the spread of normal height at one age is wide (averages hide it); weight diverges more than height; smallness predicts nothing about ability, effort or maturity; the class-average difference between schools speaks to food, not heredity (1 each).
5. Both act jointly - heredity sets ranges, environment fills them, and no classroom observation can divide the two (1); the teacher controls part of the environment - the six hours of the school day (1).
6. Reversibility - thinking through steps in any order (e.g. a multi-step comprehension task that doubles back) (1); decentration - holding two features at once (e.g. height and width of the water glasses) (1).
7. Emotional regulation developed - the feeling did not vanish, the response to it changed (1); the room made wrong answers survivable - the teacher's reaction to errors, over months (1).
8. Demanding the next stage early (symbols before concrete experience) and resting at the current stage forever (concrete materials with a class ready for rules) (1 for both named, 1 for any accurate example).
9. Concrete before symbolic (1); the order: handle or see the thing, then pictures of it, then the symbols for it (1).
10. Any two domains applied accurately, e.g. social - no group role, so give him one; emotional - regulation still developing, so teach a named strategy (1 per domain + matching response, up to 3 marks total: 1 for two domains named, 1 for apt responses, 1 for the responses following from the readings).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 using the analytic scheme below.

ERQ 1 - the engines in one pupil

Criterion	Marks
Each engine is defined accurately and separated from the other two	5
Evidence from the case (laces, birds, copying, improving hand) is matched to engines correctly, without invention	5
The teaching/waiting distinction is drawn with a way to tell them apart (<i>Analyze</i>)	6
Plain, accurate, organised writing within the word count	4

ERQ 2 - the two staff rooms

Criterion	Marks
Both explanations are represented fairly, at their strongest	4
The assessment uses the unit's principles (range-filling, averages, spread) rather than assertion (<i>Analyze</i>)	6
The consequence argument: what each explanation leads a school to do and stop doing	6
Plain, accurate, organised writing within the word count	4

ERQ 3 - two readings of one pupil

Criterion	Marks
What the clips demonstrate (conservation, stage difference) is stated accurately	5
The labels are tested against what would justify them, not merely contradicted (<i>Analyze</i>)	6

Criterion	Marks
Each pupil's teacher receives a different, doable implication	5
Plain, accurate, organised writing within the word count	4

ERQ 4 - matched or mismatched

Criterion	Marks
The mismatch is located in a named domain and stage, not a vague "too hard"	5
The redesign is the same content in a different order or form, with its principle named (<i>Analyze</i>)	7
The description of what the mismatch produced is drawn from the actual lesson	4
Plain, accurate, organised writing within the word count	4

ERQ 5 - the whole unit in one room

Criterion	Marks
Each pupil is read through the right domain and stage, with the evidence named	6
Each response follows from its reading and is doable by one teacher in one week (<i>Analyze</i>)	8
The plan treats the four readings as positions on roads, not as verdicts	3
Plain, accurate, organised writing within the word count	3

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